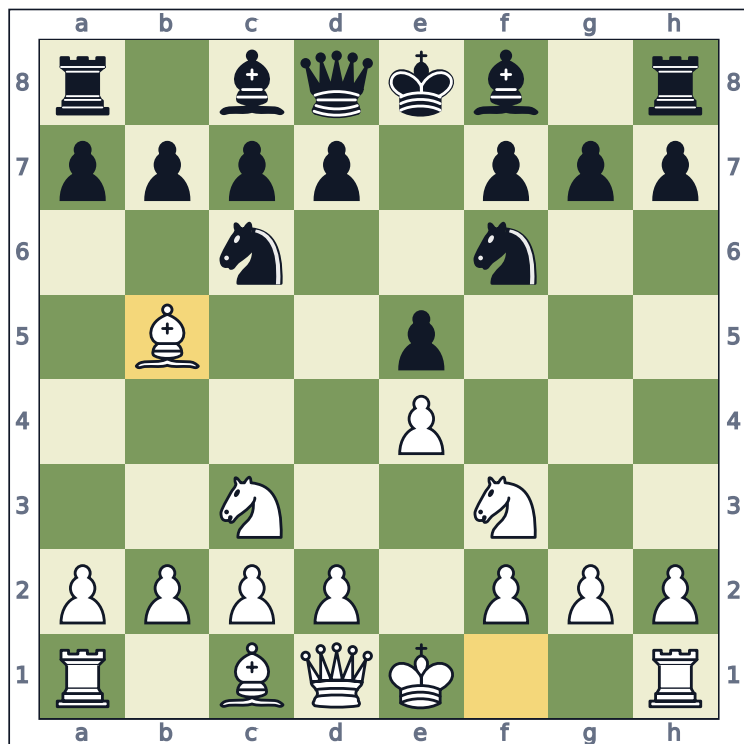


OPEN GAMES AFTER 1.E4 E5

Four Knights Game

ECO C48 | 13 named lines in this code



Featured opening position - gold marks the last move

IS IT A GOOD OPENING?

Good and fully playable. The position remains within a normal opening balance for both sides.

ENGINE SNAPSHOT

+0.27 for White. A shallow opening score is a guide, not a forced result.

GAME CHARACTER

Principled and instructive: development and central breaks lead naturally into the middlegame.

WHAT THIS OPENING IS

C48 covers Four Knights Game. Both sides contest the center directly, so development, king safety, and tactical accuracy become visible very early. The diagram uses the featured line Four Knights Game: Spanish Variation.

DEFINING ROUTE

1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Nc3 Nf6 4. Bb5

UNDERSTAND THE POSITION

What both sides are trying to achieve

WHITE'S GOALS

Develop with threats, prepare d4 under favorable conditions, castle, and use any lead in development before it disappears.

BLACK'S GOALS

Neutralize pressure on e5, complete development, and use ...d5 when it solves the center in one move.

PAWN BREAKS - THE ENGINE OF THE OPENING

White's d4 and Black's ...d5 are the central freeing breaks. The f7 and f2 squares demand tactical attention.

PIECE MAP

Knights normally reach f3/c3 and f6/c6 quickly; bishops choose active diagonals according to the central tension. The central pawn placement should decide where each bishop and knight belongs.

WHAT USUALLY GOES WRONG

Pawn grabbing and early queen moves are especially dangerous when the center can open with tempo. Recheck the center after every opponent deviation; opening names do not make moves automatic.

POSITION SNAPSHOT

Black moves next. Material is level. Central markers: White pawn on e4, Black pawn on e5.

WHO SHOULD STUDY IT?

Among the best openings for learning classical chess because strategic principles and tactics reinforce each other.

COMPLETE CODE CONTENTS

Every named C48 line

This section preserves all 13 names and defining routes assigned to C48 in the source catalogue. Different move orders can reach the same position; learn the structures and goals before memorizing labels.

001 Four Knights Game: Spanish Variation

1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Nc3 Nf6 4. Bb5

002 Four Knights Game: Spanish Variation, Bardeleben Variation

1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Nc3 Nf6 4. Bb5 Bc5 5. O-O O-O 6. Nxe5 Nxe5 7. d4 Bd6 8. f4 Nc6 9. e5 Bb4

003 Four Knights Game: Spanish Variation, Classical Variation

1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Nc3 Nf6 4. Bb5 Bc5

004 Four Knights Game: Spanish Variation, Ranken Variation

1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Nc3 Nf6 4. Bb5 a6 5. Bxc6

005 Four Knights Game: Spanish Variation, Rubinstein Variation

1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Nc3 Nf6 4. Bb5 Nd4

006 Four Knights Game: Spanish Variation, Rubinstein Variation

1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Nc3 Nf6 4. Bb5 Nd4 5. Be2

007 Four Knights Game: Spanish Variation, Rubinstein Variation

1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nf6 3. Nc3 Nc6 4. Bb5 Nd4 5. Nxe5 Qe7 6. f4

008 Four Knights Game: Spanish Variation, Rubinstein Variation Accepted

1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Nc3 Nf6 4. Bb5 Nd4 5. Nxd4

009 Four Knights Game: Spanish Variation, Rubinstein Variation, Henneberger Variation

1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nf6 3. Nc3 Nc6 4. Bb5 Nd4 5. O-O

COMPLETE CODE CONTENTS

Every named C48 line

This section preserves all 13 names and defining routes assigned to C48 in the source catalogue. Different move orders can reach the same position; learn the structures and goals before memorizing labels.

010 Four Knights Game: Spanish Variation, Rubinstein Variation, Marshall Gambit

1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Nc3 Nf6 4. Bb5 Nd4 5. Ba4 Bc5 6. Nxe5 O-O

011 Four Knights Game: Spanish Variation, Rubinstein Variation, Marshall Variation

1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Nc3 Nf6 4. Bb5 Nd4 5. Nxe5 Bc5 6. O-O O-O

012 Four Knights Game: Spanish Variation, Rubinstein Variation, Maróczy Variation

1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Nc3 Nf6 4. Bb5 Nd4 5. Be2 Nxf3+ 6. Bxf3 Bc5 7. O-O O-O 8. d3 d6 9. Na4 Bb6

013 Four Knights Game: Spanish Variation, Spielmann Variation

1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Nc3 Nf6 4. Bb5 a6 5. Bxc6 dxc6 6. Nxe5 Nxe4 7. Nxe4 Qd4 8. O-O Qxe5 9. Re1 Be6 10. d4 Qd5